

Conjunctions

A CONJUNCTION CONNECTS WORDS, PHRASES, AND CLAUSES.

Also known as connectives, conjunctions are used to link two or more parts of a sentence. These parts can be of equal importance, or a main clause can be linked to a subordinate clause using a subordinator.

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- Relative pronouns such as **who**, **whom**, **which**, and **that** are used in the same way as subordinators.
- It's a good idea to avoid starting a sentence with conjunctions like **because** or **and** because this practice often results in **incomplete sentences**.

Coordinating conjunctions

Without conjunctions, writing would be made up of numerous short sentences. Conjunctions are used to create longer sentences, preventing text from becoming stilted. Coordinating conjunctions are used to link words, phrases, or clauses of equal importance. They include the words *and*, *but*, *or*, *nor*, *yet*, *for*, and *so*.

roses **and** sunflowers

This coordinating conjunction is being used to link two types of flowers.

Flora tried to water her roses **and**
She cut **both** the hedge **and** the



- Never use a comma to link two main clauses. **Main clauses** should only be linked using a **conjunction**, a **semicolon**, or a **colon**.

GLOSSARY

Main clause A group of words that contains a subject and a verb and makes complete sense on its own.

Subordinate clause A group of words that contains a subject and a verb but depends on a main clause for its meaning.

Pairs of conjunctions

Conjunctions can be single words or phrases, and they often appear in pairs. Pairs such as *both–and*, *either–or*, and *not only–but also* are sometimes known as “correlative conjunctions” because the conjunctions work together. The two parts must be placed directly before the words they are joining.

She cut **both** the hedge **and** the tree.

pair of conjunctions

nouns being joined by the pair